Mariano Marcos State University
SDG 15 · Life on Land

STORYBOARD · CHAPTER 12 OF 13

# 12

# Reducing plastic waste on campus

5 frames

15 LIFE ON LAND

THE STORY

## From a 2009 programme to a 2025 commitment: Styrofoam out, bottled water out, reusables in.

MMSU'S COMMITMENT

Take an active role in protecting and promoting sustainable use of terrestrial ecosystems, responsible land use, and biodiversity conservation.

THE FILMSTRIP · 5 FRAMES

2025 Ongoing programme




AT A GLANCE

**2009**
programme approved

**2016**
Styrofoam policy

**30**
bags in a monthly clean-up

1 Jul 2025 · Bauang, La Union

**1 Jul 2025**
signed

**2**
laws supported

1 JUL 2025 · BAUANG, LA UNION

# MMSU Commits to the DENR-EMB Region I Regional Ecology Center

1. **THE COMMITMENT**
   MMSU signed a memorandum of commitment with DENR-EMB Region I and other agencies, private sector representatives, NGOs and academic institutions for the Regional Ecology Center.
2. **WHO SIGNED**
   MMSU was represented by Vice President for Planning and Strategic Foresight Mee Jay Domingo and Campus Sustainability Chief Ronnel Pagurayan.
3. **WHAT MMSU DOES**
   Supports improved solid waste management under RA 9003 and the Extended Producer Responsibility Act (RA 11898) through education and public information campaigns and informational materials.

**1 Jul 2025**
signed

**2**
laws supported

**Source:** MMSU News, “MMSU commits to ecological solid waste management in Region I,” 2 July 2025




*MMSU Advocates for Cultural Development clean-up drive on campus, 24 October 2025. (Photo: MMSU)*

24 OCT 2025 · UNIVERSITY GROUNDS, STUDENT CENTER AND UNIVERSITY LAGOON

# Student Advocates Hold Monthly Clean-Up Drive on Campus

1. **THE DRIVE**
   The MMSU Advocates for Cultural Development (MACD), an organisation of students from indigenous peoples' communities, held its monthly "iPaglilinis" clean-up.
2. **THE SCOPE**
   Around the university grounds, the Student Center and parts of the University Lagoon.
3. **THE RESULT**
   About 30 bags of waste collected and segregated into plastic, paper and tin materials.

| 30 | Monthly |
|---|---|
| bags collected | clean-up drive |

**Source:** MMSU News, "MACD leads clean-up drive in MMSU," 29 October 2025

TIMELINE · HOW THE POLICY BUILT UP

- **2009** — Integrated Waste Management Program approved by the Board of Regents
- **2015** — Programme amended
- **11 Feb 2016** — Policy eliminating Styrofoam and plastic as secondary packaging: paper bags, cartons, eco-bags, reusable containers
- **2020** — Revised as the Integrated Pollution and Waste Management Program (IPWMP)
- **24 Apr 2022** — “No Bottled Water” Policy, Memorandum No. 22-148A
- **24 Apr 2023** — “No Bottled Water” Policy reissued, Memorandum No. 23-189
- **Oct 2024** — CAFSD bans plastic bottled water in its auxiliary buildings
- **1 Jul 2025** — Memorandum of commitment with DENR-EMB Region I (RA 9003, RA 11898)

POLICIES 2009 → 2025 PART 1 OF 2

# MMSU Policies Eliminate Styrofoam and Reduce Plastic Waste on Campus

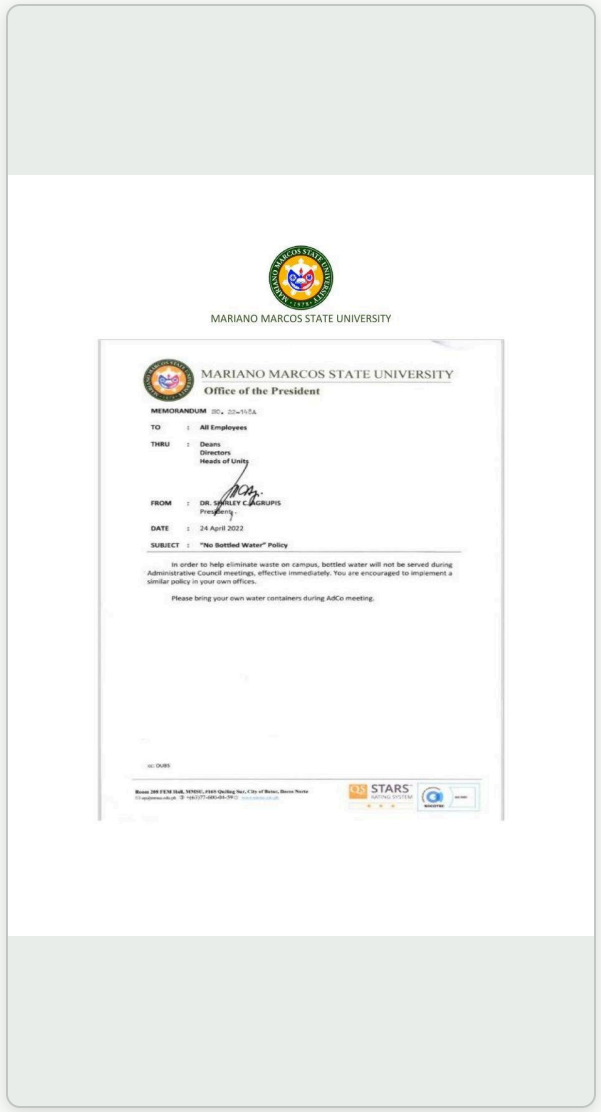
Policies · 2009, 2015, 2016, 2022 and 2023, with 2024 and 2025 actions

1. **THE PROGRAMME**
   The Integrated Waste Management Program prohibits Styrofoam for serving or packing food in the university Food Service Unit and limits plastics; the revised IPWMP carries it forward.
2. **THE 2016 POLICY**
   Eliminates Styrofoam and plastic as secondary packaging in favour of paper bags, cartons, eco-bags and reusable containers.
3. **WHO KEEPS IT**
   The University Waste Management Committee develops, reviews and monitors the rules; the food service unit requires customers dining out to bring their own food containers.

**2009**
programme approved

**2016**
Styrofoam policy

**Source:** MMSU, Plastic Waste Management (SDG 15 page) · MMSU, Revised Integrated Pollution and Waste Management Program · MMSU Office of the President, “No Bottled Water” Policy, Memorandum No. 22-148A (2022) and No. 23-189 (2023) *+2 more on the last page*


MARIANO MARCOS STATE UNIVERSITY

MARIANO MARCOS STATE UNIVERSITY
Office of the President

MEMORANDUM NO. 22-148A

TO : All Employees

THRU : Deans
Directors
Heads of Units

FROM : DR. SHIRLEY C. AGRUPIS
President

DATE : 24 April 2022

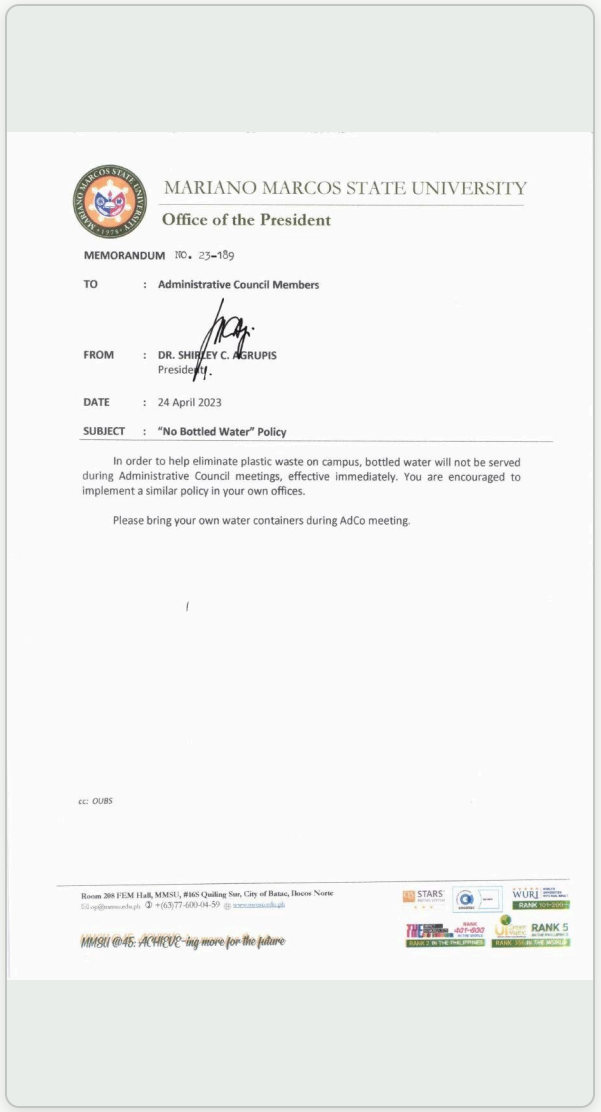
SUBJECT : "No Bottled Water" Policy

In order to help eliminate waste on campus, bottled water will not be served during Administrative Council meetings, effective immediately. You are encouraged to implement a similar policy in your own offices.

Please bring your own water containers during AdCo meeting.

cc: OUBS

*Document: Office of the President Memorandum No. 22-148A, "No Bottled Water" Policy, 24 April 2022.*


MARIANO MARCOS STATE UNIVERSITY
Office of the President

MEMORANDUM NO. 23-189

TO : Administrative Council Members

FROM : DR. SHIRLEY C. AGRUPIS
President

DATE : 24 April 2023

SUBJECT : "No Bottled Water" Policy

In order to help eliminate plastic waste on campus, bottled water will not be served during Administrative Council meetings, effective immediately. You are encouraged to implement a similar policy in your own offices.

Please bring your own water containers during AdCo meeting.

cc: OUBS

Room 208 FEM Hall, MMSU, #165 Quiling Sur, City of Batac, Ilocos Norte

MMSU @45: ACHIEVE-ing more for the future

*Document: Office of the President Memorandum No. 23-189, "No Bottled Water" Policy, 24 April 2023.*

MEMORANDA · 24 APRIL 2022 AND 24 APRIL 2023 PART 2 OF 2

# "No Bottled Water": The Office of the President Reissues the Policy Each Year

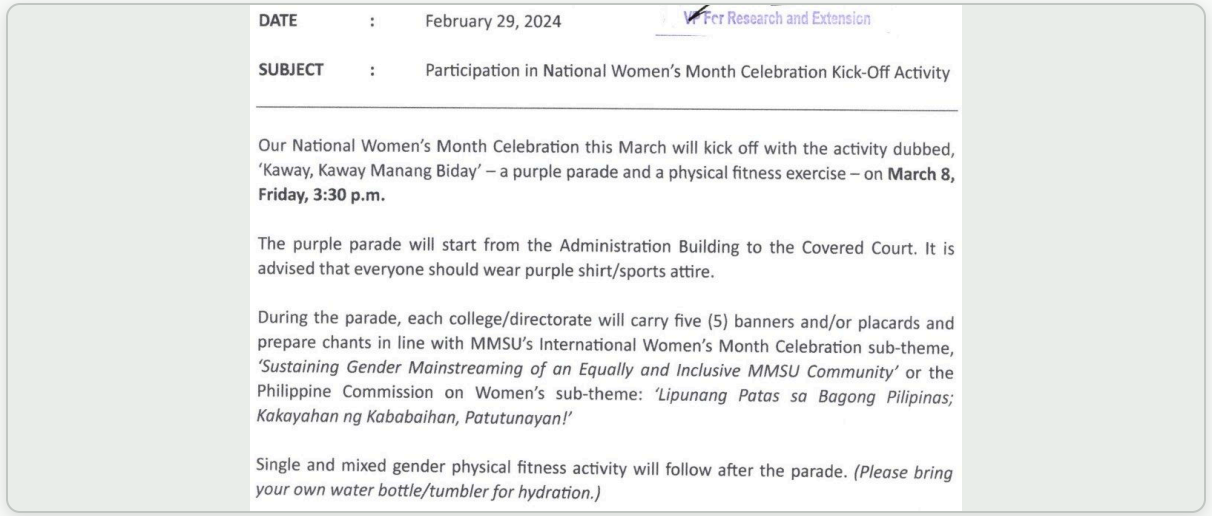
Policies · 2009, 2015, 2016, 2022 and 2023, with 2024 and 2025 actions

1. **THE MEMORANDA**
   Memorandum No. 22-148A (24 Apr 2022) and No. 23-189 (24 Apr 2023) stop the serving of bottled water at Administrative Council meetings and ask members to bring their own water containers.
2. **THE REACH**
   Both memoranda encourage all offices to adopt the same policy.
3. **THE FOLLOW-ON**
   In October 2024 CAFSD banned plastic bottled water in its auxiliary buildings; on 1 Jul 2025 MMSU signed the DENR-EMB Region I memorandum of commitment.

**2022**
first memorandum

**2023**
reissued

**Source:** MMSU, Plastic Waste Management (SDG 15 page) · MMSU, Revised Integrated Pollution and Waste Management Program · MMSU Office of the President, "No Bottled Water" Policy, Memorandum No. 22-148A (2022) and No. 23-189 (2023) *+2 more on the last page*



DATE : February 29, 2024

For Research and Extension

SUBJECT : Participation in National Women's Month Celebration Kick-Off Activity

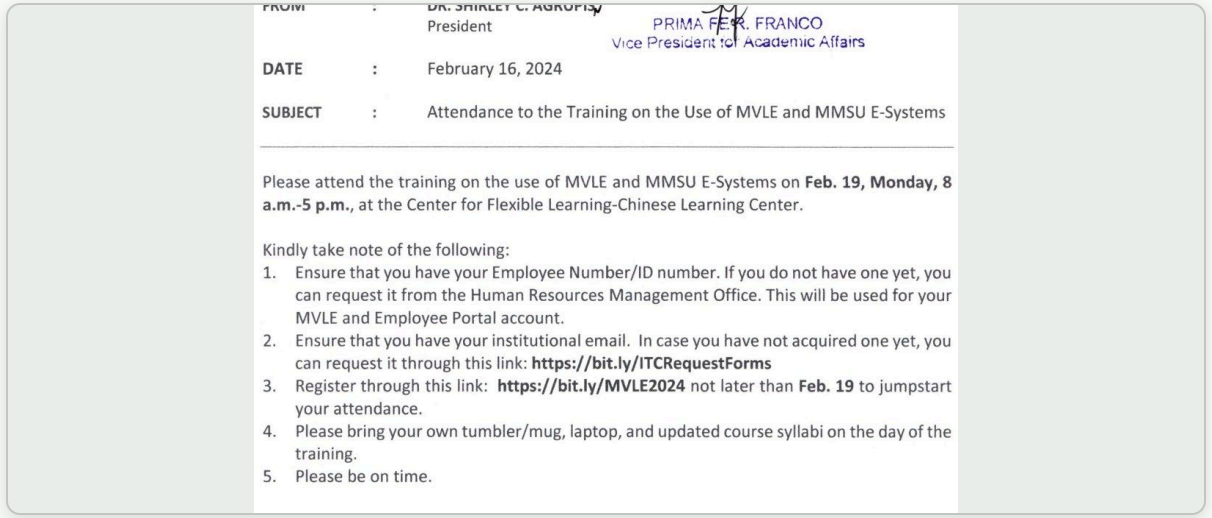
Our National Women's Month Celebration this March will kick off with the activity dubbed, 'Kaway, Kaway Manang Biday' – a purple parade and a physical fitness exercise – on **March 8, Friday, 3:30 p.m.**

The purple parade will start from the Administration Building to the Covered Court. It is advised that everyone should wear purple shirt/sports attire.

During the parade, each college/directorate will carry five (5) banners and/or placards and prepare chants in line with MMSU's International Women's Month Celebration sub-theme, *'Sustaining Gender Mainstreaming of an Equally and Inclusive MMSU Community'* or the Philippine Commission on Women's sub-theme: *'Lipunang Patas sa Bagong Pilipinas; Kakayahan ng Kababaihan, Patutunayan!'*

Single and mixed gender physical fitness activity will follow after the parade. *(Please bring your own water bottle/tumbler for hydration.)*

*Document: Office of the President Memorandum No. 24-088, 29 February 2024, to all employees: "Please bring your own water bottle/tumbler for hydration."*



FROM : DR. SHIRLEY C. AGRUPIS
President

PRIMA FE R. FRANCO
Vice President for Academic Affairs

DATE : February 16, 2024

SUBJECT : Attendance to the Training on the Use of MVLE and MMSU E-Systems

Please attend the training on the use of MVLE and MMSU E-Systems on **Feb. 19, Monday, 8 a.m.-5 p.m.**, at the Center for Flexible Learning-Chinese Learning Center.

Kindly take note of the following:

1. Ensure that you have your Employee Number/ID number. If you do not have one yet, you can request it from the Human Resources Management Office. This will be used for your MVLE and Employee Portal account.
2. Ensure that you have your institutional email. In case you have not acquired one yet, you can request it through this link: **https://bit.ly/ITCRequestForms**
3. Register through this link: **https://bit.ly/MVLE2024** not later than **Feb. 19** to jumpstart your attendance.
4. Please bring your own tumbler/mug, laptop, and updated course syllabi on the day of the training.
5. Please be on time.

*Document: Office of the President Memorandum No. 24-075, 16 February 2024, item 4: "Please bring your own tumbler/mug…"*

FEB 2024 · MEMORANDA NO. 24-075 AND 24-088 · OCT 2024

# University Memoranda Ask Employees to Bring Their Own Tumblers

Ongoing programme · February 2024

**1 THE PRACTICE**

Office of the President Memorandum No. 24-088 (29 Feb 2024, all employees) asked participants to "bring your own water bottle/tumbler for hydration."

**2 THE SAME MONTH**

Memorandum No. 24-075 (16 Feb 2024) asked newly hired faculty attending MVLE training to "bring your own tumbler/mug."

**3 THE NEXT STEP**

In October 2024 CAFSD banned plastic bottled water in its auxiliary building and encouraged reusable tumblers.

**2**
memoranda, Feb 2024

**Oct 2024**
CAFSD bottled-water ban

**Source:** MMSU Office of the President, Memorandum No. 24-088, "Participation in National Women's Month Celebration Kick-Off Activity," 29 February 2024 · MMSU Office of the President, Memorandum No. 24-075, "Attendance to the Training on the Use of MVLE and MMSU E-Systems," 16 February 2024 · MMSU News, "MMSU CAFSD rolls out waste and pollution management program," 15 October 2024

WHERE THE STORY LANDS

## Programme rules on Styrofoam, annual no-bottled-water memoranda, requests to bring tumblers, a college-level ban, a regional commitment and student clean-ups add up to a campus habit of cutting plastic.

**2009**
programme approved

**2016**
Styrofoam policy

**30**
bags in a monthly clean-up

THE FRAMES

1. **MMSU Commits to the DENR-EMB Region I Regional Ecology Center**
   1 Jul 2025
2. **Student Advocates Hold Monthly Clean-Up Drive on Campus**
   24 Oct 2025
3. **MMSU Policies Eliminate Styrofoam and Reduce Plastic Waste on Campus**
   Policies 2009 → 2025
4. **“No Bottled Water”: The Office of the President Reissues the Policy Each Year**
   Memoranda
5. **University Memoranda Ask Employees to Bring Their Own Tumblers**
   Feb 2024

SOURCES (8)


1. MMSU News, “MMSU commits to ecological solid waste management in Region I,” 2 July 2025
   https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/mmsu-commits-to-ecological-solid-waste-management-in-region-i
2. MMSU News, “MACD leads clean-up drive in MMSU,” 29 October 2025
   https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/macd-leads-clean-up-drive-in-mmsu
3. MMSU, Plastic Waste Management (SDG 15 page)
   https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/resources/1NU-Qda9KG0J-PIOgKZwPKC4h_TU05zcm/data
4. MMSU, Revised Integrated Pollution and Waste Management Program
   https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/resources/1fNUCZwyOozOKO27L2Bm6pNN-P_cJNpLd/view
5. MMSU Office of the President, “No Bottled Water” Policy, Memorandum No. 22-148A (2022) and No. 23-189 (2023)
   https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/resources/1LbnK8yYkg-47ChbXyT0r8VQ9eBGuMxRx/data
6. MMSU News, “MMSU CAFSD rolls out waste and pollution management program,” 15 October 2024
   https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/mmsu-cafsd-rolls-out-waste-and-pollution-management-program
7. MMSU Office of the President, Memorandum No. 24-088, “Participation in National Women’s Month Celebration Kick-Off Activity,” 29 February 2024
8. MMSU Office of the President, Memorandum No. 24-075, “Attendance to the Training on the Use of MVLE and MMSU E-Systems,” 16 February 2024